

VISION THEOLOGICAL SEMINARY

(Accredited by Asia Theological Association)

Ayswarya Garden, Parvathipuram, Nagercoil-3

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HISTORY:

Vision Theological Seminary is born out of the deep conviction that action speaks louder than words and is believed that evangelical ministries in India are possible only if committed young men and women are trained in the Bible discipline and adequate theological education; moreover, its goal is deeply rooted in equipping the dedicated men and women for the fulfillment of the great commission of our Lord Jesus Christ. We train persons of any age without denominational discrepancy. Vision Theological Seminary is founded to fulfill the plan of God on 1st August 2001 and it was accredited by ATA in 2015.

Dr.G. David Raj, the founder, principal and co-faculty of Vision Theological Seminary is having profound commitment to give significant theological training to the learners and main emphasis is given to encourage its students in their effective pastoral ministry, evangelistic career and excellence in theological education is the hall mark of Vision Theological Seminary. Apart from ATA degrees, Vision Theological Seminary offers non-ATA theological degrees as well. Vision Theological Seminary has been awarded the “**Best Theological Seminary**” award by Tamilan TV, Lions Club and Visvaseva Tele-media on 6th September 2009.

LOCATION:

Vision Theological Seminary is situated in the Southwest side of the Parvathipuram bus stand in the walkable distance of 600 ft at Ayswarya Garden in the bosom of Mother Nature with the outer set up of mountains and fields, the weather is cool and breezy with clouds drifting over the mountains, giving natural and mild wind.

PHILOSOPHY OF THEOLOGICAL EDUCATION

Some of the philosophical slogans of the Vision Theological Seminary are “Education starts from the womb and ends at the tomb” and “The day a Christian worker ceases his study he retires from his ministry.” Vision Theological Seminary is committed to educate both educated and illiterate Christian workers without age barrier for total development of equipping men and women to effectively witness

and serve Jesus Christ in the world today. VTS offers contextual and creative programs. We enable Pastors in churches and teachers in Theological institutions to make positive Christian responses to contemporary challenges, opportunities and problems in their pastoral and teaching ministries.

We are living in an age of sophisticated wisdom in which the almighty God seeks well-dedicated and well-trained aspirants to work mightily among the wisdom seeking folk, therefore theological education has paramount importance in the Christian ministerial field today. We are really enthusiastic and exceedingly glad in training up qualified and praise worthy theologians, leaders, pastors, teachers and evangelists. Our teaching standard is inter-denominationally witnessed and appreciated by leading servants of God, since it helps and makes radical changes in all agencies of the life and ministry of the servants of God.

ACCREDITATION

Our M.Div and B.Th. courses are Accredited by Asia Theological Association. ATA accredited courses are offered in English only, we also offer non-ATA courses such as B.C.S, B.D., M.A (theology) and STM courses in Tamil.

DOCTRINAL STATEMENT

- (a) We believe the Bible to be the inspired, the infallible and authoritative word of God.
- (b) We believe that there is one God, eternally existent in the three persons Fathers, Son and the Holy Spirit.
- (c) We believe in the deity of one Lord Jesus Christ, in His virgin birth, in His sinless life, in His vicarious and atoning death, in His blood shed, in His bodily resurrection, in His personal return to power and glory.
- (d) We believe that for the salvation of the lost and sinful people, regeneration of the Holy Spirit is absolutely essential.
- (e) We believe in the present ministry of the Holy Spirit by whose indwelling the Christian is enabled to live a godly life.
- (f) We believe in the resurrection of both the saved and the lost they that are saved into the resurrection of eternal life and they that are lost into resurrection of eternal damnation.
- (g) We believe in the spiritual unity of believers in Christ.

(h) We believe that the responsibility of each born-again Christian is to witness the Lord Jesus Christ.

OBJECTIVES

1. To equip men and women with academic tools for ministry of the church in diverse cultural contexts.
2. To develop proficiency in men and women in order to engage in independent and critical research relevant to the context.
3. To promote inter disciplinary perspectives leading to an integration of theological knowledge and ministerial skills.
4. To introduce innovative and effective patterns of education that will prepare students for Christian ministry in context.
5. To equip all God's people of various vocational callings in the ministry of Christian witness in the society.
6. To produce outstanding Christian leaders with effective ministry of God.
7. To equip men and women for teaching in theological colleges.
8. To enable men and women to be obedient to the call of God in fulfilling His mission with a stupendous vision.
9. To strengthen the weak in faith, to be strong in the understanding of the Bible.
10. To emphasize the need and significance of Christian maturity in modern context.
11. To develop proficiency in learners enabling them to engage in independent and contextual research which may lead to advanced study at the doctoral level.

Full Time Faculty

1. Dr.G. David Raj Ph.D. (Principal)
2. Rev. Maziha Dhas. L.B. M.A., M.Div., M.Sc (Coun & Psy)., M.Th
(Vice Principal)
3. Rev.V.Veda Novin M.Th (Registrar)
4. Rev.J.John Joseph M.Div., M.Th. (Dean)
5. M.Isaac Samuel Jha M.Th

6. Mrs. T. Mercy M.A., B.D., M.Min., M.Th. (Bursar)
7. Eva. Ensalen.B M.Div (Chaplain)
7. Mrs.D.M. Clemency B.E., M.Div-Office in charge

Part Time Faculty

1. Rev. T. Reji M.A., M.Th.
2. Rev. G. Jeba Sundar Singh M.A., M.Th.

Visiting Faculty

1. Dr. Jayaraj Kunjunni Ph.D
2. Dr.A. Christhudas Ph.D
3. Dr.Reeju Tharakan Ph.D
4. Dr. P. Rajendra Babu Ph.D

Librarian: Mrs. S.Mahiba Johncy Lib.Sc

Ass.Lib: Mr.A.R.Arul Theodore

CONTACT CLASSES

1. Students are required to attend the Tutorial sessions which will be organized for 18-22 days in a semester, every day 9.30-5pm. Faculty members of VTS and visiting professors will be giving lectures during these sessions. The dates and other details will be intimated two months before each semester.
2. There will be time for discussions, interactions and clarifications.
3. 80 percentage of attendance in the contact classes is a must for each semester examination.
4. Library is made available for study and research.
5. Students are free to clear up any doubts concerning subjects and academic requirements time to time.

ASSIGNMENTS

Each course should have its prescribed assignment. Assignments help to think more about the subjects and enable to attain 20 percentage marks of each paper. All the Assignments should be

produced according to the prescribed form, referring so many books and with endnotes. Plagiarism is strictly prohibited. Students can contact with the faculty for the clarification of writing assignments.

MEDIUM OF INSTRUCTION

Classes will be conducted in English, and students who speak in their regional languages during contact classes will be fined.

GRADING SYSTEM

There will be an examination at the end of each semester. Evaluation for each course is done as given below:

Written Examination – 60%

Written Assignments – 20%

Internal Assessment – 20 %

The following is the key to the grading system

<i>First Class</i>	<i>Second Class</i>	<i>Third Class</i>
A + (80% above)	B + (65 – 69%)	C+ (50 – 54%)
A (75 – 79)	B (60 – 64%)	C (45 – 49%)
A- (70 – 74%)	B- (55 – 59%)	C- (40 – 44%)

Failure: 39% and below

N.B: A minimum to get a pass is 40% in aggregate of each paper (8+8+24= 40)

CHAPEL SERVICE

Effective worship is conducted during contact classes. It is an occasion of stimulant to the learners. Prearranged candidates may conduct the chapel service; failure in fulfilling their charge may cause to reduction of the internal assessment mark. All the learners and faculty will be there in chapel service.

COURSES AND BASIC REQUIREMENTS

1. MASTER OF DIVINITY (M.Div)

The Master of Divinity degree is an ATA accredited degree, it is carefully worked out to meet the academic standards of post graduate degrees in universities in India and institutions accredited by Asia Theological Association all over Asia. The degree is recognized by higher educational bodies in various parts of the world for admission to research degrees.

This degree aims to equip students with an understanding of the Bible and its teachings, to give a total view of life in its spiritual, cultural, political and environmental dimensions. It has been designed to equip the whole church for its life and witness. Hence, not only pastors and teachers within the church, but also Christians actively involved in various walks of life will benefit from this study.

Eligibility & Duration

Men and women who have passed B.A., B.Th., B.A (in ministry) and experienced pastors below B.A can also apply for M.Div degree course as per ATA rule (10/1). It is a four-year course for Bachelor degree holder but three-year course for the candidates holding accredited B.Th. or B.A (in ministry) degree with second class mark.

3. BACHELOR OF THEOLOGY

This ATA accredited degree course lays more emphasis on contextual, Biblical and practical aspects of the Christian life and ministry. Those who occupied in work, some pastors or evangelist can avail this opportunity and earn a recognized theological degree while working or serving in their respective places.

Eligibility & Duration

Men and women who have passed Pre-Degree course or Higher Secondary Examination (+2) or S.S.L.C passed with any two-year Diploma certificates and experienced pastors below Higher Secondary Course can also apply for B.Th degree course as per ATA rule (10/1). It is a four-year course.

4. MASTER OF ARTS (theology)

Master of Arts in theology degree is offered by Vision Theological Seminary. This course is conducted to acquire adequate knowledge in Christian Theology. This program is designed for those who seek academic achievements.

Eligibility & Duration

It is a three-year course for those who have passed B. A, B.Th or B.A (in ministry) and B.D degree holders with second class marks can complete this course in one year.

5. BACHELOR OF DIVINITY (B.D)

It is a two-year course for Bachelor (secular) degree holders. Those who have obtained any Bachelor degree in theology or in ministry can complete in two years. It is fully designed and conducted by Vision Theological Seminary.

6. BACHELOR OF CHRISTIAN STUDIES (B.C.S)

This Bachelor degree course offered by Vision Theological Seminary, S.S.L.C passed persons can apply for B.C.S Course. (Experienced and those who are in full time ministry will be enrolled to B.C.S without basic qualification as per quota 10/1)).

7. STM (Master of Sacred Theology)

Master of Sacred Theology Degree is offered by Vision Theological Seminary. It aims to equip learners with adequate skills in critical and methodological reflection for creative participation in diversified ministries, such as pastoral, teaching, evangelism, mission work etc.

Eligibility & Duration

Men and women who have passed M.Div/M.A (theology) with second class or its equivalent degree from recognized institutions. It is a two-year course.

APPLICATION FORM, REGISTRATION FEE

M.Div applicant can get application form by paying Rs 150- and send it with Registration fee Rs 1500.

B.Th applicant can get application form by paying Rs 100- and send it with Registration fee Rs 1000.

STM applicant can get application form by paying Rs 100- and send it with Registration fee Rs 1000.

M.A (theology) applicant can get application form by paying Rs 100- and send it with Registration fee Rs 800.

B.D applicant can get application form by paying Rs 100- and send it with Registration fee Rs 700.

B.C.S applicant can get application form by paying Rs 100- and send it with Registration fee Rs 600.

ADMISSION REQUIRMENTS

Before considered for admission, each applicant is required to submit the following documents:

- a. Fill up the application form and affix stamp size photos at the light side of the application forms.
- b. A statement of Christian experience
- c. Duly attested copies of all certificates and mark statements
- d. Confidential letters of recommendations from any two of the following (from all degrees)
 - (i) Your Pastor
 - (ii) Senior leader in the Church
 - (iii) Head of the organization you belong to
 - (iv) Head of the institution last attended.

The filled-up application forms must be sent to the principal with attested Xerox copies of the certificates, testimony, recommendation letter of the local church pastor or leader of the organization and Reg fee. Applications will summarily be rejected if there is any discrepancy in the particulars presented. Incomplete applications will not be considered.

ENTRANCE EXAMINATION

M.Div, B.Th. candidates are expected to pass the following three papers in the entrance examination (paying Rs 600):

- a. Bible knowledge
- b. General knowledge
- c. English

No candidate will be allowed more than two attempts in the entrance examination.

FEE STRUCTURES (ATA Degrees)

M.Div	B.Th.
Rs 7000	Rs 5500
(in two terms)	(in two terms)

FEE STRUCTURES (Non-ATA Degrees)

STM	M.A (theology)	B.D	B.C.S
Rs 5000	Rs 4700	Rs 5500	Rs 4200
(in two terms)	(in two terms)	(in two terms)	(in two terms)

Schedule of Class and Mode of Fee Payment will be intimated to you before the commencement of each semester.

GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

1. Attendance at all the contact classes required over the period of study.
2. Passing in all the required papers, successfully completing all the assignments, research papers and integrated papers up to the course.
3. Successful completion of the Thesis and successful performance in Viva-voce.
4. Payment of all fees at the due time.
5. Demonstration of familiarity of language, where necessary for the thesis.
6. Self-improvement in all areas of life such as Christian prudence and spiritual maturity.

REQUIRED PAPERS FOR EACH COURSE**M.Div****Block I**

1. Introduction to the Bible Literature
2. Historical Books of the Old Testament Period
3. A Detailed study of the Book of Acts
4. History of Christianity

Block II

1. A General Study of Pentateuch
2. Life and Work of Jesus Christ
3. Homiletics
4. Major Religions in India

Block III

1. Christian Theology
2. Prophetical Movement in Israel
3. Christian Education and Nurture
4. General Epistles

Block IV

1. Pauline Letters to the Corinthians
2. Poetical and Wisdom Literature
3. Modern Religious and Secular Movements in India
4. Ephesians and Philippians
5. Preliminary Study of Hebrew Language

Block V

1. A Detailed Study of the Book of John
2. History of Christianity in India
3. Life and Work of Christian Minister
4. Pastoral Epistles
5. Preliminary Study of Greek Language

Block VI

1. A Detailed study of the Book of Daniel
2. Christian Ethics
3. Pastoral Care and Counselling
4. Mission and Evangelism
5. A Detailed Study of the Book of Hebrews

Block VII

1. A Detailed Study of the Book of Revelation
2. Indian Christian Theology
3. Christian Apologetics
4. Church Organization and Administration
5. A Detailed study of the Book of Romans

Block VIII

1. Leadership and Management Techniques
2. Health and Hygienic Studies
3. Biblical Archeology
4. Problem Solving Techniques

B.Th./ B.C.S**Block I**

1. New Testament Survey
2. Old Testament Survey
3. Christian Theology-I
4. A Detailed Study of the Book of Acts
5. Major Religions in India

Block II

1. Synoptic Gospels
2. History of Israel
3. Prophetical Movement in Israel
4. Biblical Hermeneutics
5. Christian Theology-II

Block III

1. Pauline Epistles
2. History of Christianity-I
3. Christian Worship
4. Theology of Mission
5. Bible Manners and Customs

Block IV

1. Minor Prophets
2. History of Christianity-II
3. Christian Education and Nurture
4. Theology of Work and Self-Support
5. History of Reformation Period

Block V

1. Poetical and Wisdom Literature
2. Introduction to Psychology
3. Romans and Galatians
4. Pastoral Epistles
5. Evangelism

Block VI

1. General Epistles
2. A General Study of Christian Ethics
3. History of Christianity in India
4. Pastoral Care and Counseling
5. Ephesians and Philippians

Block VII

1. Pentateuch
2. Homiletics
3. MRSM
4. Daniel and Revelation
5. Spiritual Leadership

Block VIII

1. Health and hygienic Studies
2. Gender Studies
3. Problem Solving Techniques
4. Indian Constitution & Christianity
5. Modern Church History

STM**Block I**

1. Exegetical study of the Epistle to the Galatians
2. Exegetical study of the Book of Job
3. Exegetical study of the Book of Ezra
4. Exegetical study of Psalms 1-50

Block II

1. Exegetical study of the Gospel of Matthew
2. Exegetical study of Psalms 51-100
3. Exegetical study of the Book of Nehemiah
4. Exegetical Study of the Minor Prophets

Block III

1. The Book Revelation Ch 1-10
2. Exegetical study of the Book of Esther
3. Exegetical study of Psalms 100-150
4. Exegetical Study of the Book of Jeremiah

Block IV

1. The Book Revelation Ch 11-22
2. Exegetical study of Psalms 101-150
3. Exegetical study of the Book of Ezekiel
4. Leadership Psychology

Thesis: Research product should be approximately of 20,000 words.

M.A. (theology) / B.D

Block I

1. Pauline Letters to the Corinthians
2. Life and Work of Christian Minister
3. Major Religions in India
4. History of Christianity
5. Introduction to the Bible Literature

Block II

1. Prophetical Movement in Israel
2. Homiletics
3. Life and Work of Jesus Christ
4. A General Study of Pentateuch
5. Christian Theology

Block III

1. Modern Religious and Secular Movements in India
2. Christian Education and Nurture
3. History of Christianity in India
4. A Detailed study of the Book of Daniel
5. A Detailed Study of the Book of John

Block IV

1. A Detailed Study of the Book of Revelation
2. Christian Ethics
3. Mission and Evangelism
4. Indian Christian Theology
5. Pastoral Epistles
6. Preliminary Greek Language

Block V

1. A Detailed Study of the Book of Hebrews
2. A Detailed study of the Book of Romans
3. A Detailed study of the Book of Acts of the Apostles
4. Historical Books of the Old Testament Period
5. Christian Apologetics

6. Preliminary Hebrew Language

Block VI

1. Church Organization and Administration
2. Ephesians and Philippians
3. Poetical and Wisdom Literature
4. General Epistles
5. Pastoral Care and Counseling

Note: Students are liable to accept the changes made by the faculty time to time in matters of discipline and fee structure.